

Simon Raymond

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[Personal Website](#)

[Github](#)

Education

- **Saint Mary's University (SMU)**, Halifax, NS
Bachelor of Commerce, Honours Economics | *Graduated: May 2025*
Overall GPA: 4.21/4.30
Notable Coursework
 - *Mathematical Economics* (ECON 3302, A+)
 - *Intermediate Economic Stats* (ECON 3303, A-)
 - *Money and Banking* (ECON 3307, A+)
 - *Machine Learning and Artificial Intelligence* (ECON 3838/MBAN 5560, A+)
 - *Labour Economics* (ECON 3341, A+)
 - *Advanced Microeconomics* (ECON 4400, A+)
 - *Advanced Macroeconomics* (ECON 4401, A+)
 - *Econometrics* (ECON 4403, A+)
 - *Research Seminar* (ECON 4498, A+)
 - *Honours Thesis* (ECON 4499, A+)
 - *Special Topics in Microeconomics* (ECON 4404, A+)
- **University of Waterloo**, Waterloo, ON
Masters of Economics (MRP) | *Expected Graduation: Summer 2026*
Notable Coursework
 - *Econometrics* (ECON 621, 91/100)
 - *Microeconomic Theory* (ECON 601, 100/100)
 - *Data Science for Economist* (ECON 607, 91/100)
- **McGill University**, Montreal, QC
Doctor of Philosophy (PhD), Economics | *Incoming: September 2026*
Awarded a multi-year funding package of approximately \$42,000/yr for 5 years.

Awards and Scholarships

- **University of Waterloo Graduate Scholarship:** Awarded a scholarship valued at approximately \$10,000 per-semester for graduate studies beginning September 2025, including two Teaching Assistant positions.
 - **SMU's Renewable Entrance Scholarship:** Maintained an academic scholarship for four years at SMU. Valued at approximately \$4,000 per year.
 - **SMU's Renewable Entrance Scholarship Achievement:** Received an increase in scholarship amount in second year of university due to academic success. Valued at approximately \$3,000.
 - **J.D. Shatford Memorial Trust Scholarship:** Received this merit-based scholarship during first two years of university. Valued at approximately \$4,000-\$6,000 per year.
 - **Dean's List Recognition:** Placed on the Sobey School of Business Dean's List from 2022-2023.
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Research Assistant Experience

- **Lead Researcher** | Mass Culture
 - *February 2026 – April 2026* Leading research on the economic impact of the arts and culture sector in Canada. Responsible for conducting analysis, directing team members and communicating with researchers outside of the organization.
- **RA for Dr. Yigit Aydede**
 - *2023-2025* Assisted in research projects that worked with census and geographical housing data. Responsibilities included data collection, cleaning, and preliminary analysis using both R and Python.

Working Papers and Papers in Preparation

- *“Fourth Downs Decoded: A Predictive and Causal Analysis of Player Impact and Decision Making in the NFL”*
 - **Submitted:** January 2026
 - **Co-authors:** Simon Raymond and Dr. Nick Manuel
 - We Implement a non-parametric form of the Heckman Correction. Our framework allows us to empirically prove the exogeneity of our corrective instrument which allows us to make bias-free inference on factors that effect 4th down attempts in the NFL. While many revisions have been recently made, a version that was my honours thesis can be viewed [here](#).
 - **Target Journal:** The Journal of Sports Economics
 - **Application:** View an older version of what our engineered data looks like [here](#).
- *“Non-exporter to Exporter: Making the Shift”*
 - **Authors:** Dr. Ron Kalafsky, Dr. Mark Raymond, Simon Raymond
 - Using Craft Alliance and Halifax Partnership data this paper looks to find key factors that contribute to a small businesses’ success in exporting.
 - **My Role:** I was in charge of the cleaning and engineering of all our raw data. I also performed the preliminary analysis. To view our first report see [here](#).
- *“The Cold Hand: Evidence in tournament 9-ball and NFL kickers”*
 - Investigating the effect of a player making consecutive shots on their probability of making the next attempt in competitive 9-ball and within NFL kickers. We will also look at the effect of when a player has not taken a turn at the table or to kick for an extended period of time. This will allow us to identify if individuals perform better or worse for purely psychological reasons when they have not been able to act.

Presentations & Speaking Engagements

- **Speaker** | *“Demystifying AI: Beyond the code”* | Saint Mary’s University
Presented at this event hosted by Dr. Yigit Aydede at SMU, sharing insights on artificial intelligence applications. Featured in SMU news for presenting to high school students participating in the Youth Business Analytics & AI Co-op Program.
- **Radio Guest** | CBC Mainstreet NS | May 1, 2025
Spoke with CBC Radio about agentic AI at the Atlantic AI Summit 2025. The interview aired on Mainstreet NS in the afternoon. [Link to program](#)
- **Invited Presentation** | 2025 Fall Symposium on Growing Exports in Nova Scotia | October 15, 2025
Contributed to “Non Exporter to Exporter: Making the Shift” that was presented at the Arthur L. Irving Entrepreneurship Centre, SMU. View the overview of the symposium [here](#).

Teaching Experience

- **Winter 2024:** Appointment to teach lab session:
 - *Machine Learning and Artificial Intelligence* (MBAN-5560-2 at SMU). In this lab I used R to teach students about how to understand machine learning algorithms and concepts. I taught students how to write algorithms with tools such as XGBoost or Random Forest. Students also learned how to truly understand what is happening inside these functions as we showed them how to write non-parametric models from scratch.
- **Winter 2025:** Appointment to teach lab session:
 - *Machine Learning and Artificial Intelligence* (MBAN-5560-2 at SMU). These labs were taught similarly to the previous year. However, it was taught with the Python programming language as well.

- **Fall 2025:** Appointment to teach lab session:
 - *Econometric Analysis 2* (ECON 323 at UofW). This lab is taught both on a whiteboard and in R. Sessions are weekly for approximately 80 students in which we apply methodologies that were discussed in class. See course outline [here](#).
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Grading Experience

- **Past Appointment (Fall 2024):**
 - *Human Resource Economics* (ECON 3340) with Dr. Nick Manuel. This course had 40 students registered in it. My task was to grade assignments and provide feedback to students.
 - **Past Appointment (Winter 2025):**
 - *Machine Learning and Artificial Intelligence* (MBAN-5560-2) with Dr. Yigit Aydede. I marked the assignments and final projects of approximately 25 students.
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Professional Experience

- **Data Analyst & Deployment Assistant | Nova Storm | 9 Months**
Worked as an intern at Nova Storms, contributing to data analytics projects and software development. I was involved in developing agentic AI business applications that have practical implications. See [Nova Storms](#) for more information. I worked specifically on the following three projects;
 - *Nova Scotia Neighborhood app* An application that helps residents explore detailed neighborhood demographics census data to help families and businesses make informed decisions on where to be located.
 - *Nova Scotia Crime Dashboard app*: A previously deployed public tool that provides Halifax residents with interactive crime data.
 - *Nova Scotia Housing Wizard*: A dashboard that allows buyers, sellers, and agents to analyze historical housing trends with agentic AI capabilities.
 - **Data Analyst | Craft Alliance Atlantic Association | 2025**
Conducted data engineering work for the Atlantic Canada Small Scale Manufacturers Sector Survey, converting raw survey data into clean, analysis-ready datasets. I also provided statistical analysis and advanced modeling support for our research team. To see more of my work look [here](#).
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Personal Projects

- **Machine Learning Baseline**
 - Developed a [bookdown](#) in my third year of my undergraduate degree that holds basic skeletons of algorithms that are used in machine learning using R. It also contains some specific applications in sports and survey data.
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Other Work Experience & Extra-curricular Activities

- **Grocery Stocker | Bell's Independent Grocer | 2016-2023** This employment was from when I was age 13 through high school and university. I worked part-time (under 20 hours/week) up until I turned 15. Afterwards I worked (30-40 hours/week).
 - **Cashier's Assistant | Costco | 2023-2024** This job includes helping customers bag their groceries and working as a cashier when needed. I worked 30-40 hours/week during academic breaks (e.g. reading weeks, Christmas, summer).
 - **CCO** Catholic Christian Outreach (CCO) is a student led club on campuses across Canada. At SMU I have taken five faith studies with CCO. In my second year of studies I was a part of the student-lead executive while leading a faith study.
 - **4-H** 4-H is a youth development organization that empowers young people through hands-on learning experiences in agriculture, science, leadership, and life skills. I have taken the beef, sheep, poultry, exploring 4-H, and great outdoors projects.
 - **HCC Household program** Holy Cross Chaplaincy (HCC) is a faith based organization that has physical chaplaincies on university campuses across Canada. I was a participant of their household program that lets young adults be in a living situation that helps promote spiritual growth and community.
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References

- **Dr. Yigit Aydede**
Chair, Department of Economics
Sobey School of Business, Saint Mary's University
Contact: yigit.aydede@smu.ca
- **Dr. Nick Manuel**
Assistant Professor, Department of Economics
Sobey School of Business, Saint Mary's University
Contact: nicholas.manuel@smu.ca
- **Dr. Anqi Li**
Assistant Professor, Department of Economics
University of Waterloo
Contact: anqi.li@uwaterloo.ca
- **Dr. Dinghai Xu**
Professor, Department of Economics
University of Waterloo
Contact: dhxu@uwaterloo.ca

Links

These are provided in the case that an institution's software prevents clicking on a hyperlink in the document.

- **Personal Website:** (<https://simonraymond2003.github.io/SimonRaymond/>)
- **Github:** (<https://github.com/SimonRaymond2003/>)
- **Honours Research Paper:** (<https://library2.smu.ca/handle/01/32122>)
- **NFL 4th Down Analysis (2016-2023):** (<https://huggingface.co/spaces/SimonRaymond/NFLdata>)
- **Nova Storm:** (<https://novastorms.com/>)
- **Craft Alliance Atlantic - Sector Survey:** (<https://craftalliance.ca/craft-sector-survey-2025/>)
- **Non-Exporter to Exporter Report:**
(https://craftalliance.ca/wp-content/uploads/2025/10/Report_NonExporterToExporter.pdf)
- **ECON 323 Course Outline:** (<https://outline.uwaterloo.ca/viewer/view/nz7un8>)
- **SMU News Article - AI Co-op Program:** (<https://news.smu.ca/news/2025/4/29/halifax-high-schoolers-gain-skills-in-ai-at-smu>)
- **CBC Mainstreet NS Program:** (<https://www.cbc.ca/listen/live-radio/1-37-mainstreet-ns>)
- **2025 Fall Symposium on Growing Exports:** (<https://www.forestns.ca/events/2025-fall-symposium-on-growing-exports-in-nova-scotia>)
- **Machine Learning Baseline (Bookdown):**
(<https://simonraymond2003.github.io/MachineLearning/index.html>)